

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦A

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4 3
 ♥ Q 6
 ♦ K 9 6
 ♣ A K 7 5 2

♠ A K Q 8 6
 ♥ A K 10 8 2
 ♦ A
 ♣ 8 6



♠ J 9 5
 ♥ J 4
 ♦ J 10 8 5 3
 ♣ J 10 4

♠ 7 2
 ♥ 9 7 5 3
 ♦ Q 7 4 2
 ♣ Q 9 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♦J			

NORTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣. SOUTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2♦.

NORTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠. SOUTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

NORTH now shows her second suit, 3♥.

SOUTH is happy to bid the game in ♥s.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 3
♥ 9 8 2
♦ A Q J 8 6
♣ J 2

♠ J 9 8 6

♥ J 7 6 4

♦ 4 3

♣ 6 4 3



♠ A Q 2
♥ A K Q 5
♦ K 7 5
♣ K Q 10

♠ 10 5 4

♥ 10 3

♦ 10 9 2

♣ A 9 8 7 5

EAST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

WEST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is ♦s she must jump to the 3-level.

EAST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

WEST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by East			
Lead: ♠5			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 4 3
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ A 9 6 4 3
 ♣ 9 7 6 2

♠ A 10 9 7 2

♥ 9 7 5

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A 3



♠ Q J 8 5

♥ 10 8 6

♦ 10 7

♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ K 6

♥ A K Q J 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q J

NORTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH bids her ♥s and NORTH agrees the trump suit with a 4♥ bid.

SOUTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that NORTH holds two Aces she bids 6NT. She could also have bid 6♥ but 6NT scores a little more.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ A			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 10 3

♥ A K 6

♦ 8 6

♣ A Q 4

♠ 8 7 5

♥ Q J 10 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ 10 8 5



♠ J 4 2

♥ 8 7 5 2

♦ J 7 2

♣ K 6 3

♠ 9 6

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 10 9 3

♣ J 9 7 2

West

2♣

2♠

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♥Q

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♦

3♠

South

Pass

Pass

EAST has 5 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid.

WEST bids his 5-card ♠ suit.

EAST is too good for the second negative, so she supports WEST's ♠.

WEST doesn't have enough to think about slam, so he signs off at 4♠.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 3

♥ 10 8 3

♦ K 10

♣ 10 9 2

♠ K J 7 2

♥ A 7 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 6 5 3



♠ 9 6

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ Q J 8 7

♠ A Q

♥ K Q J 2

♦ A Q 9 8

♣ A K 4

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

NORTH has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

SOUTH figures NORTH for 8 points and bids 6NT. If NORTH has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♣7			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 8 2

♥ A 5

♦ A K 2

♣ A K 2

♠ A 9 6 5

♥ 10 9 7 4

♦ Q 5 3

♣ Q 3



♠ 7

♥ K Q J 8 3 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 8 7 4

♠ 10 4 3

♥ 6

♦ J 10 7 4

♣ J 10 9 6 5

WEST opens 2♣ and EAST, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

WEST should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And EAST can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for WEST to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

West

2♣

2♠

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Lead: ♦J

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♥

3♥

South

Pass

Pass